



HISTORIC EDEN CEMETERY · PROJECT WALK-THROUGH

Brand Narrative, Tour & Technical Architecture

PREPARED FOR HISTORIC EDEN CEMETERY BY 1838 BLACK METROPOLIS · OCTOBER 2026

TODAY AND THE ROAD AHEAD

Walk through it now. Live with it in October. Finalize by year-end.

Nothing is locked — this is a draft for you to react to.

LATE SEPTEMBER

Walk-through & handover

The document, the website, the plans.

OCTOBER

Your feedback

Read it. Click through it. Share it with your board.

NOVEMBER – DECEMBER

Finalize

Your changes folded in. Tour finalized.



SECTION 1

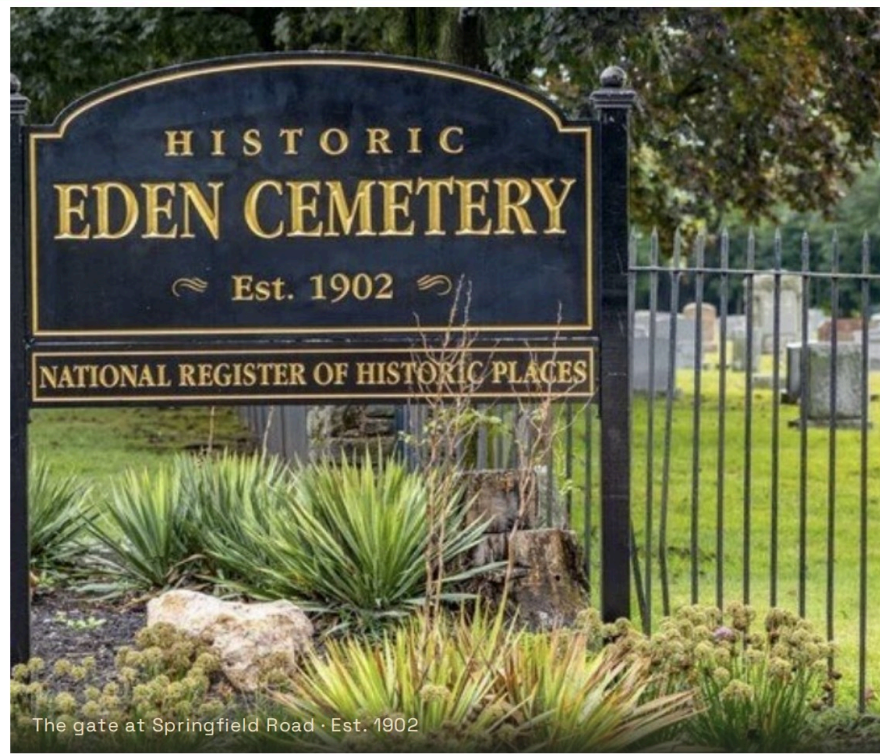
Brand Narrative & Awareness Strategy

The core story of a Black institution built to preserve dignity, memory, and permanence.

Chapel of the Lebanon Cemetery · Historical Society of Pennsylvania

CORE POSITIONING

Not simply a burial ground.



The gate at Springfield Road • Est. 1902

NORTH STAR

A place created so that dignity continues in death, where the lives of Black Philadelphia remain visible, protected, and connected to future generations.

1902 93,000 53

Founded — for you,
by you

Lives • 17,000 lots

Acres of sacred
ground

BRAND PROMISE & PRIMARY BRAND IDEA

What Eden protects.



The Anderson-DePreist family stone

BRAND PROMISE

Eden protects more than graves. It protects the **dignity, evidence, memory, and continuity of Black life.**

PRIMARY BRAND IDEA

From displacement to dignity.
From burial to memory.
From the ancestors to us.

HOW EDEN SHOULD SOUND

Reverence. Agency. Intimacy. Consequence.

Never morbidity, nostalgia, or generic heritage tourism.



The Bascom family

Sacred, not solemn-only

Historically grounded

Black-centered & self-determined

Accessible, not flattened

Present-tense

Headline copy

Eden held them. Eden holds us still.

That's ours.

93,000 lives. One sacred Black archive.

Where Black Memory Lives.

NARRATIVE PILLARS

Five ways into one story.



01

Dignity as Resistance

Black-controlled burial space is an act of agency.



02

The Collection Cemetery

It gathered what the city displaced.



03

Black Philadelphia in Full

The famous and the familiar.



04

Memory Across Generations

Where descendants find evidence of themselves.



05

A Living Future

Preservation is not backward-looking.

Say it in thirty seconds.



THE F.U.B.U. PITCH

In 1902, Black Philadelphians did something radical: they built their own. For You. By You. Ninety-three thousand souls on Black-owned, Black-controlled sacred ground. *That's ours.* It still is.



THE REINTERMENT PITCH

Lebanon. Olive. The great Black burial grounds were forced to close. Only theirs. *Even in death, the mistreatment continued.* But Eden held them. Eden holds them still.



THE TIME-TRAVEL PITCH

Sit in the same space as Marian Anderson, Frances Harper, and William Still. *Time travel — the past in the present.* Come sit with your ancestors. Eden won't let you forget.

AUDIENCE MESSAGING

One story, different doorways.

The story stays the same; the reason to care changes.

BLACK PHILADELPHIANS

**Find your people.
Claim what's yours.**

Visit • Bring family • Research •
Support

NATIONAL AUDIENCES

**American history
through Black lives.**

Visit • Add Eden to heritage
itineraries

FUNDERS & SPONSORS

**Protect 93,000
records and a rare
landscape.**

Fund preservation • digitization
• education • access

MEDIA

**Permanence in
response to
dispossession.**

Cover Eden as a living
institution

STRATEGIC SEQUENCING

Three workstreams, in order.

Build awareness first.

WORKSTREAM 1	Awareness	Website • sponsorship • community partnerships
WORKSTREAM 2	Sustainability	Sponsorship and financial sustainability
WORKSTREAM 3	Social media	Facebook for events, one official page • other platforms only when Eden can sustain them

Restore Eden to the cultural map.



Octavius V. Catto • Lebanon Section, Lot 124

1 • WEBSITE

Make Eden's significance immediately legible

Understand the story in seconds. Know what to do next.

2 • COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS

A place to visit, learn, gather

Churches • Divine Nine • schools • HBCU alumni • genealogists • cultural institutions

Preservation without resources is vulnerability.

CORE SPONSORSHIP MESSAGE

*Preserving Eden means preserving evidence:
names, families, institutions, stories,
monuments, records — and the ground itself.*

Who to approach: Philadelphia-region corporations · foundations for Black history and archives · institutions whose own histories intersect with people buried at Eden.



Section books and interment ledgers · Eden Cemetery archive

Facebook for events. The rest when Eden can sustain it.

- One official Eden page — consolidate the five scattered pages
- Post every program and partner event there — Eden looks active because it is
- Instagram by cross-posting — a setting, not a second job
- One volunteer, one job
- Events feed the website — no website edits

THE GATE TO OPEN OTHER PLATFORMS

Capacity · a content pipeline · governance · someone who answers within a day.

Four types of partners.

Match every prospect to one — never a generic ask.



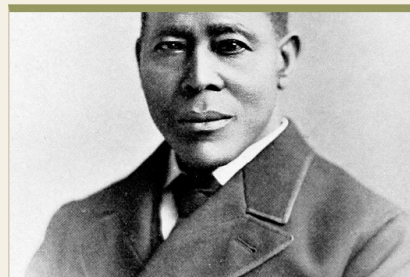
Preservation Partner

Monuments · landscape · archives · historic sections



Digital Memory Partner

Digitization · mapping · searchable family history



Education Partner

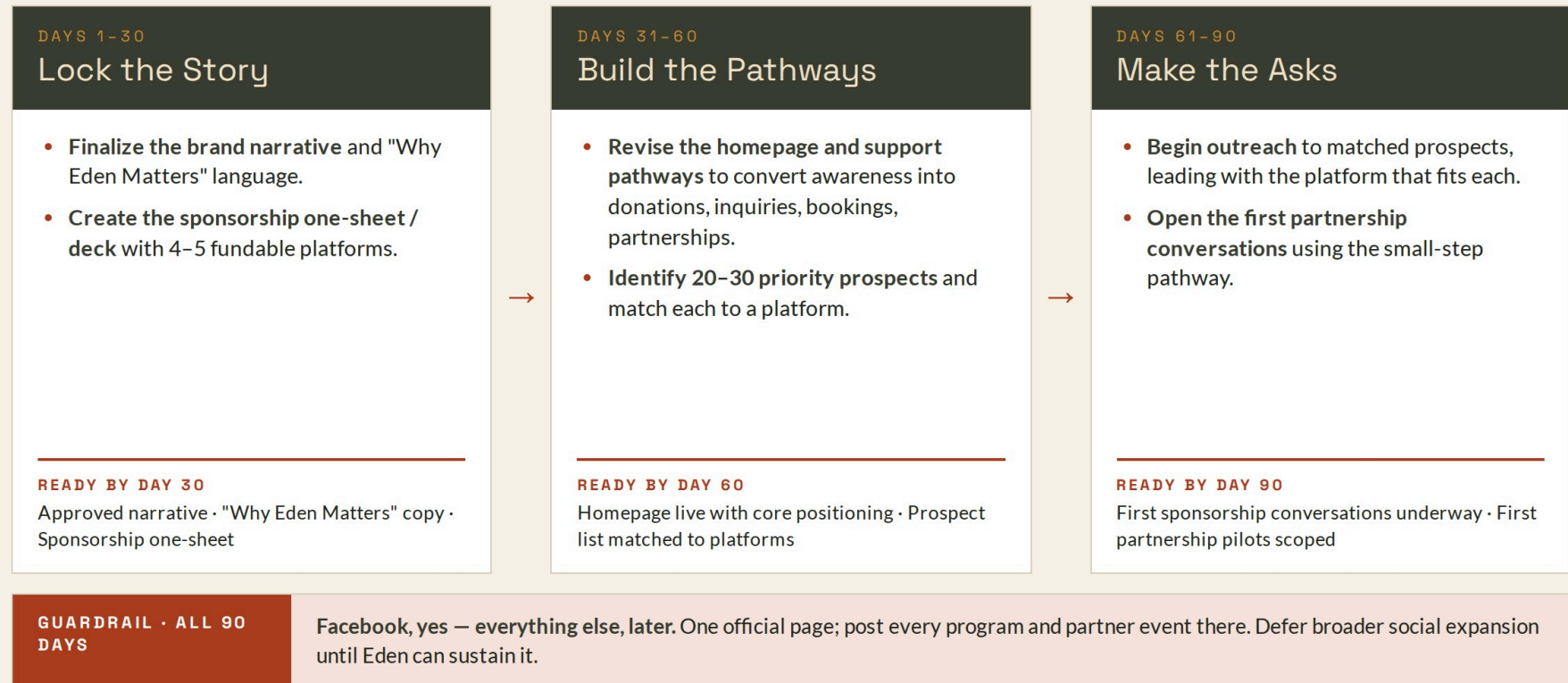
School visits · tours · public-history programs



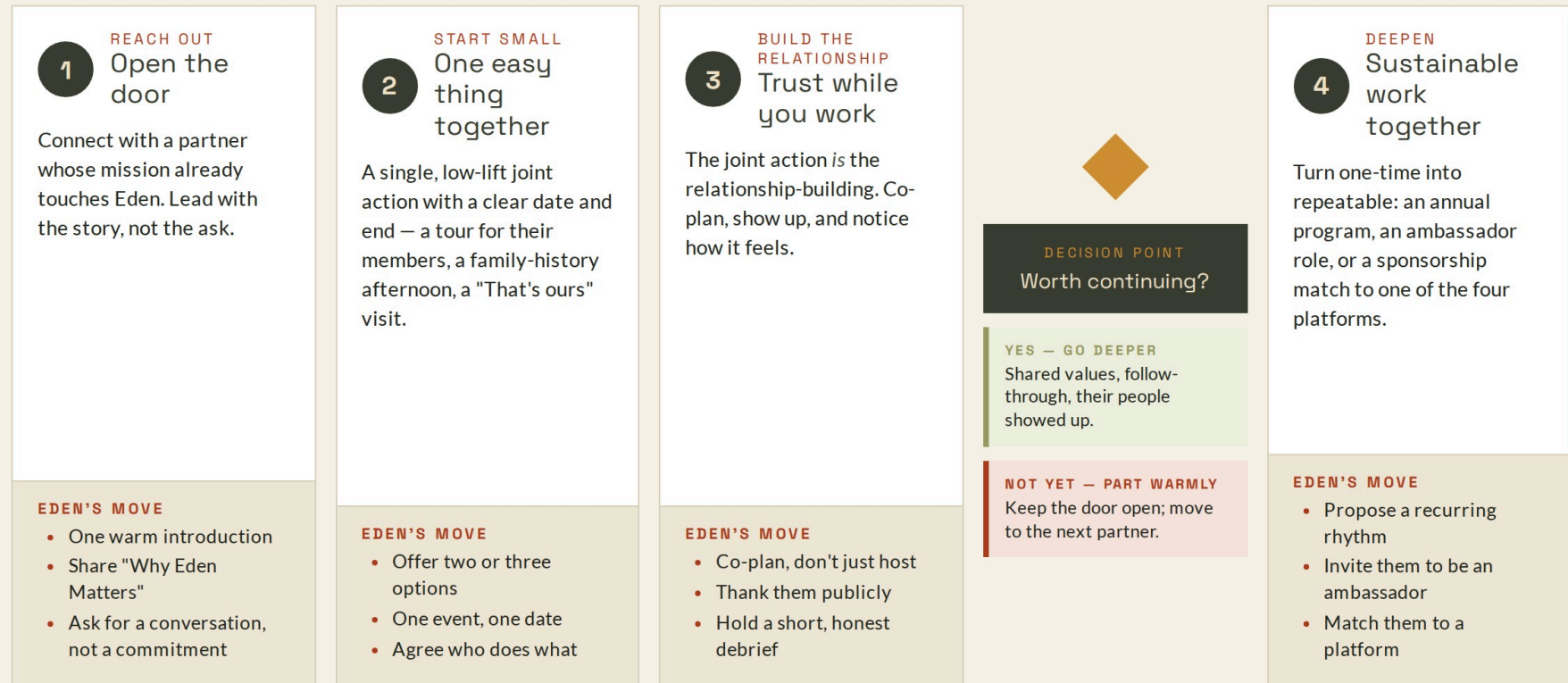
Community Legacy Partner

Community days · genealogy · remembrance

One story. One set of tools. Matched asks.



Test small. Learn fast. Grow what proves itself.



SECTION 2

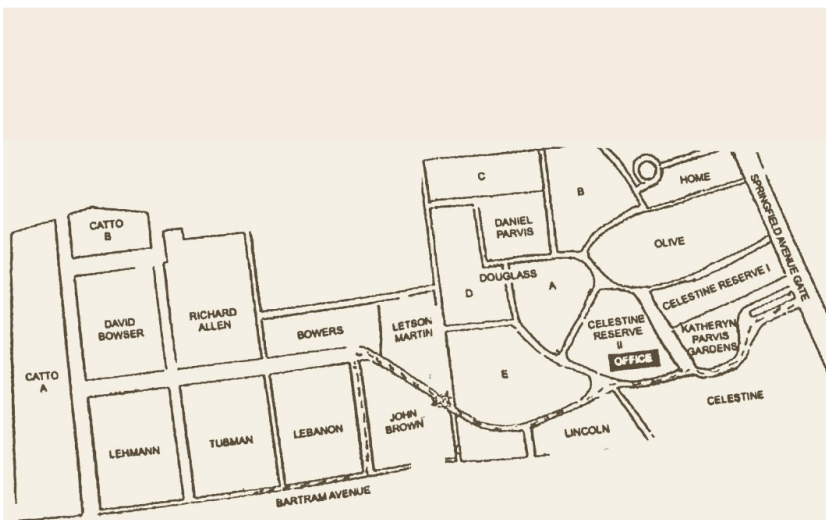
Tour

RICHARD ALLEN

Bringing the brand narrative onto the grounds — two self-guided walks on the website, told through Eden's section names.

Themes that guide the walk.

One question at every stop: how does Eden continue the tradition of preserving generations of Black life, Black Community Building, and Black Institution Building?



Eden's sections • the ground the tour walks

THEME 1

Black control over burial

Free African Society, 1787 → Eden's charter, 1902

THEME 2

Displacement and reinterment

Lebanon and Olive — lost cemeteries whose names live on

THEME 3

Building Eden

Celestine's first burial • Lehmann and the five founders

THEME 4

Continuity across generations

Forten → Still → Catto • Whipper → Fauset • Cole, Anderson, Blockson

Live demo • self-guided walks

Full • 8 stops • 90–120 min | Short • 4 stops •

60 min

[Full tour →](#)

[Short tour →](#)

1902 is the pivot.

The walk opens at Eden's founding, flashes back a century, returns to 1902, then moves forward to today.

1787

RICHARD ALLEN

Free African Society — Black control of death and burial before Eden

1902

CELESTINE ·
LEHMANN

Eden chartered · Still dies · Celestine's funeral resisted · five founders

1903

LEBANON

A condemned cemetery's dead arrive — displacement and continuity

1911

JOHN BROWN

Harper chooses a section named for abolition

1923

OLIVE

A second lost cemetery — reform to the Harlem Renaissance

1922–2023

CELESTINE,
REVISITED

Cole · Anderson · Marian Anderson · Blockson choose Eden

Today

CLOSING

Stewardship and contested reinterment — the question stays open

Transferred — or buried here.

The one distinction every visitor carries away. Every person is introduced with how they arrived.

TRANSFERRED

Moved to Eden with an earlier cemetery — Lebanon in 1903, Olive in 1923.

DIRECT BURIAL

Buried at Eden after the section already existed — by choice.

ELSEWHERE NOW

Once at Eden; remains have since been returned or removed.

UNCONFIRMED

Sequence still to be checked in Eden's registers.

ONE PAIRING TELLS IT

Catto was moved here in 1903 because Lebanon was condemned.

LeCount was buried beside him twenty years later — by choice.

Catto represents displacement. LeCount represents return.

FOUR PLACES

Absalom Jones: St. Thomas → Lebanon → Eden → back to St. Thomas in 1991. Reinterment was rarely a single event.

Connections, not stops.

No one stands alone. Each stop points to a person in another section — with a gesture toward that ground.



William Still • Lebanon • the generational bridge

LEBANON → OLIVE

Forten → Whipper

The American Moral Reform Society — two generations of Black reform.

LEBANON → JOHN BROWN

Still → Harper

Philadelphia's abolitionist and Underground Railroad network.

WITHIN LEBANON

Still → Catto → LeCount

The fight to desegregate the city's streetcars.

LEBANON → CELESTINE

The Still-Anderson family

Abolition • medicine and education • Berean Presbyterian Church.

LEBANON → OLIVE → CELESTINE

Waring → Fauset → Marian Anderson

A painter, the writer she traveled with, and the singer she painted — art, literature, and music across three sections.

Every stop, the same six beats.

So the tour stays consistent whoever is leading it.

1

The name

What the section commemorates — and whether the namesake is actually buried there.

2

The people

A few who rest here, each introduced by how they arrived.

3

The connection

"Still worked with Harper, whom we'll meet in John Brown." Gesture toward it.

4

One or two more

People who deepen the network or extend the chronology.

5

If time permits

A lesser-known person, a theme, or a larger issue — body-snatching, displacement, commemoration.

6

The transition

Why the group is moving to the next section.

Allowing for Interpretation.

CONFIRMED

Ready to say aloud.

OPTIONAL

Confirmed, but expendable when time is short.

RESEARCH NOTE

Promising — not yet ready for public interpretation.

WHAT GUIDES DON'T SAY YET

- That Eden was William Still's first burial — until the 1902 register confirms it. He is simply "buried here."
- That Lehmann lies in the Lehmann section — the documented fact is that it was named for him.
- That Cole, Anderson, and the Mossells were friends — they were an overlapping medical network.

The tour stays honest while Eden's own registers are still being read.

Two walks. One script.

FULL TOUR • 8 STOPS • 90-120 MIN

For visitors who can walk and stand.
Springfield Road entrance to Celestine and back.

SHORT TOUR • 4 STOPS • 60 MIN

Designed for limited mobility, not trimmed from the long route: short distances, a seat at every stop, **fewer stops with richer stories.**

Both carry the same content advisory — grave disturbance, racism, reinterment — and the same guide kit.



THE WALK ENDS IN THE PRESENT

Who cares for Eden now — and what remains unresolved. The MOVE children, First African Baptist, the Morton Collection.

Who decides where Black bodies rest — and whether those places are protected?

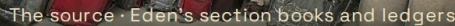


SECTION 3

Technical Architecture

What has been delivered — and how Eden keeps it running with almost no cost and limited technical resources.

From scanned pages to a searchable record.



Original Database from Scanned Word Documents

Every entry as written, with its source page

Cleaned Database from Scanned Word Documents

Standardized names, sections, lots,
dates

Cleaned Notables Database for Website

Edit this to update the directory

Cleaned Full Lot Index with Coordinates

~17,000 lots, each with coordinates

Come sit with your ancestors.

[Home](#)[History](#)[Notable Residents](#)[For Kids](#)[Map & Tours](#)[Find a Lot](#)[Friends of Eden](#)[Contact](#)[Open the live site →](#)

TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

Technical Recommendations

A powerful website that is low cost and low maintenance — and social interaction on existing free tools.

THE WEBSITE

Self-contained. Eden owns it.

No CMS, no subscription. Get off Squarespace.

FACEBOOK + INSTAGRAM

The living room. One official page.

Programs, events, and partner news live there — and feed the website.

PEOPLE

One volunteer • 50 hours • Penn Praxis

Social volunteer now. 1838 this year. Students next year.

WHAT THIS COSTS EDEN

The hosting fee Eden likely already pays.

~\$0–100
a year

NEXT STEPS

October is yours.

YOU RECEIVE TODAY

- The full document (PDF + Word)
- The live website
- The data folder

TELL US

- Does it sound like Eden?
- What's missing or wrong?
- Which partners first?

NOVEMBER - DECEMBER

- Your feedback folded in
- Tour pages final
- Final handover



Eden held them.
Eden holds us still.

Thank you. — 1838 Black Metropolis · Reclaim. Rewrite. & Restore.